INCH-POUND

MIL-C-82876(OS)
15 November 1993

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CATAPULT, AIRCRAFT EJECTION SEAT, CKU-5B/A ASSEMBLY

This specification is approved for use by the Naval Sea Systems Command, Department of the Navy, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for the Rocket Catapult CKU-5B/A loaded assembly.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplements thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-P-116	Preservation-Packaging, Methods of
MIL-S-9479	Seat System, Upward Ejection, Aircraft, General Specification for
MIL-P-46994	Pellet, Boron Potassium Nitrate
MIL-P-82652	Propellant, Solid, Composite
MIL-P-82680	Propellant, Solid, Composite

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, Indian Head Division, Naval Surface Warfare Center, Standardization Branch (Code 8420), 101 Strauss Avenue, Indian Head, MD 20640-5035, by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by sending a letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 1377

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-413	Visual Inspection Guide for Elastomeric O-rings
MIL-STD-414	Sampling Procedures for Inspection by Variables
MIL-STD-453	Inspection, Radiographic
MIL-STD-810	Environmental Test Methods and Engineering Guidelines
MIL-STD-1168	Ammunition Lot Numbering
MIL-STD-1907	Inspection, Liquid Penetrant and Magnetic Particle, Soundness Requirements for Materials, Parts, and Weldments
MIL-STD-1949	Inspection, Magnetic Particle
DOD-STD-2101	Classification of Characteristics
MIL-STD-2102	Aircrew Escape Propulsion Systems; Vibration and Shock Tests for
MS17983	Compass, Magnetic, Pilots Standby

(Unless otherwise specified, copies of federal and military specifications and standards are available from Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents and drawings. The following other Government documents and drawings form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

CODE OF FEDERAL REGULATIONS

49 CFR 100-199	Transportation

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington D.C. 20402-0001.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

DRAWINGS

Naval Surface Warfare Center, Indian Head Division (CAGE Codes 19200 and 19203)

DL6610113 Catapult, Aircraft Ejection Seat, CKU-5B/A Assembly

(Application for copies should be addressed to: Commander, Indian Head Division, Naval Surface Warfare Center, Attn: Data Control Branch (Code 8410), Indian Head, MD 20640-5035.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

E 165 Liquid Penetrant Inspection Method

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., ATA Traffic Department, 2200 Mill Road, Alexandria, VA 22314.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee Agent, Tariff Publication Officer, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.5) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Materials. All materials, parts, and assemblies shall be in accordance with DL6610113 and this specification.

3.2.1 Primary components. Only primary components from a single primary component lot shall be used in a production lot of loaded rocket catapults.

3.2.2 Propellant. The rocket motor propellant shall be in accordance with MIL-P-82680, Class III.

3.3 Age of explosive components. The following paragraphs give the requirements for controlling the age of explosive components.

3.3.1 Propellant. The propellant is defined as the rocket motor grain (motor tube and grain assembly per Drawing D11744246) and the cartridge grain (cartridge case and grain assembly per Drawing C11740607). For purposes of this section, loaded is defined as when the rocket catapult lot is released for lot acceptance testing.

3.3.1.1 Rocket motor grain. The rocket motor grain shall be loaded within 180 days of the oldest rocket motor propellant mix.

3.3.1.2 Cartridge grain. The cartridge grain shall be loaded (when the cartridge case is crimped) within 180 days of the oldest cartridge propellant mix. The crimped cartridge must be loaded into the rocket catapult within 240 days of oldest cartridge propellant mix.

3.3.2 Other explosive components. The other explosive components are the percussion primer (Drawing 11820864), the $BKNO_3$ pellets (MIL-P-46994, Type II-A), and the propellant shavings (MIL-P-82652).

3.3.2.1 Percussion primers. The percussion primers shall be loaded within 24 months of manufacture and certification or within 12 months of recertification. Loaded is defined as when the cartridge case is crimped.

3.3.2.2 $BKNO_3$ pellets and propellant shavings. The $BKNO_3$ pellets and propellant shavings shall be loaded into the rocket catapult within 12 months of the certification date. Loaded is defined as when the rocket catapult lot is released for lot acceptance testing.

3.4 Performance and product characteristics. The rocket catapults shall meet the following performance and product characteristics when test fired at −65°F, 70°F, and 165°F using an ejected weight of 375 pounds.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4.1 Ballistics. The rocket catapults shall meet the ballistic requirements specified in table I.

TABLE I. Ballistic performance requirements for a 375-pound ejected weight.

Parameter	-65°F		70°F		165°F		AQL
	Min	Max	Min	Max	Min	Max	
Catapult							
Initiation pressure, see 6.4.5 (psi)	400	600	400	600	400	600	–
Dynamic response index, see 6.4.7 (DRI)[1/]	–	18.0	–	18.0	–	22.0	0.65
Separation velocity, see 6.4.6 (ft/s)[2/]	35	–	35	–	35	–	0.65
Ignition delay, see 6.4.4 (ms)	–	30	–	30	–	30	0.65
Axial thrust (lb_f)	–	7000	–	7000	–	7000	1.0
Pressure (psi)	1200	–	1200	–	1200	–	1.0
Rocket Motor							
Resultant impulse, see 6.4.1 (lb_f/sec)	950	–	950	–	950	–	1.0
Ignition delay, see 6.4.4 (ms)	–	30	–	30	–	30	1.0
Action time, see 6.4.2 (ms)[3/]	–	500	–	500	–	500	1.0
Resultant thrust, see 6.4.3 (lb_f)	–	5000	–	5000	–	5000	0.65
Thrust angle (reference)[4/]	52°		52°		52°		–

1/ DRI is defined in MIL-S-9479 (see 6.4.7).
2/ Nominal separation velocities are: 39.0 ft/s at -65°F and 47.0 ft/s at 165°F.
3/ Nominal rocket motor action time is: 460 ms at -65°F and 330 ms at 165°F.
4/ Record for information only.

3.4.1.1 Other requirements. In addition to meeting the ballistic requirements, none of the following shall occur during test firing of rocket catapults:

a. No unit component, including but not limited to cartridge components, O-rings, springs, or pieces of propellant shall be ejected.

b. No component subject to loading shall fail.

c. No excessive nozzle erosion, hot spots, or burnthrough shall occur.

d. No leakage of ballistic gas past a sealing surface shall occur.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4.2 Initiation. Maximum allowed initiation pressure is 10,000 psi. The rate of pressurization input shall be 10,000 to 50,000 psi/sec.

3.5 Hydrostatic pressure. The components listed in table II shall withstand the internal hydrostatic pressure specified for 15 seconds minimum when tested in accordance with 4.5.6.2.

TABLE II. Hydrostatic pressure requirements.

Component	Drawing	Hydrostatic pressure (psi)
Motor Tube	11726650	5,000
Launcher Tube	11726655	12,000
Booster Tube	11726656	12,000

3.6 Radiographic. Each loaded rocket catapult shall be examined radiographically to ascertain the presence, condition, and correct placement of internal components.

3.7 Torque. The booster tube and breech assembly, when seated with a torque of 400 +50, −0 inch-pounds, shall not be loosened or deformed when subjected to a breakaway torque of 200 inch-pounds.

3.8 Protective finish. Protective finish shall be in accordance with the applicable specifications and drawings and shall apply to all surfaces of the component regardless of configuration.

3.9 Residual magnetism. The rocket catapult assembly, when passed in front of an MS17983 compass along the entire length of the catapult (see figure 1) shall not cause the compass indicator to deflect more than 5 degrees in either direction.

3.10 Environmental. The rocket catapult assemblies shall withstand the environmental conditioning of 3.10.1 through 3.10.4. Rocket catapult assemblies subjected to this conditioning shall show no evidence of deterioration of propellant or disarrangement of components when examined in accordance with 4.5.6.1 and shall meet the ballistic performance requirements of 3.4 when test fired in accordance with 4.4.2.

3.10.1 High temperature. The rocket catapult shall withstand the high temperature test of 4.4.1.1.

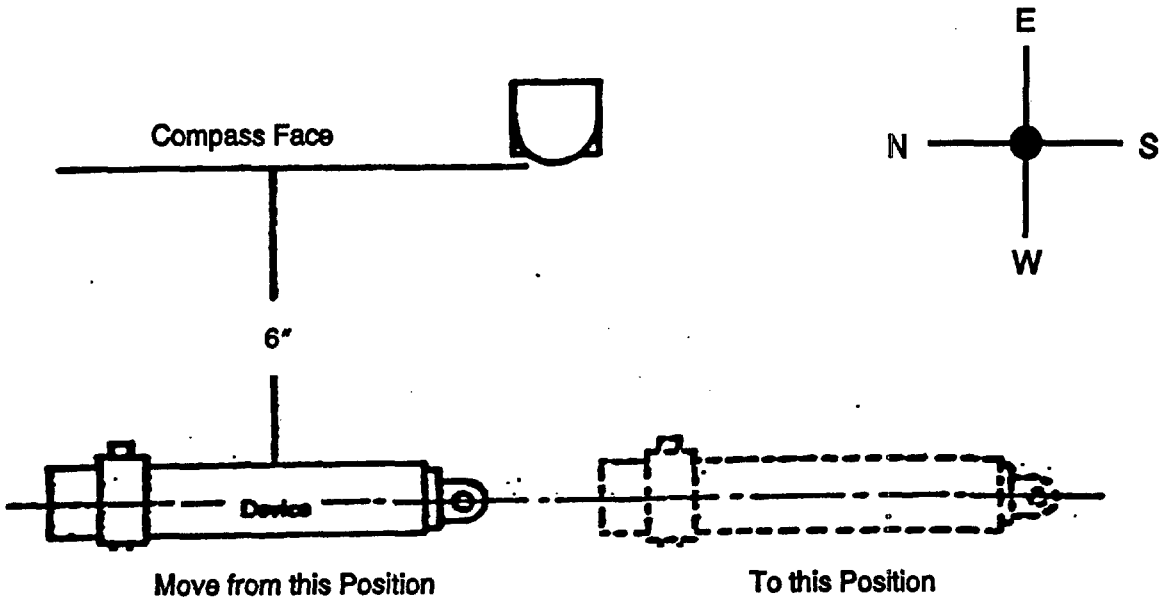
3.10.2 Vibration. The rocket catapult shall withstand the vibration test of 4.4.1.2.

3.10.3 Temperature-shock. The rocket catapult shall withstand the temperature-shock test of 4.4.1.3.

3.10.4 Thirty-day storage test. The rocket catapult shall withstand the 30-day storage test of 4.4.1.4.

3.11 Identification markings. Each rocket catapult shall be marked in accordance with Drawing 6610113 with an identification label, an instruction label, a warning label, and an installation label.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



Plan View

NOTE: Device and compass shall lie in a common horizontal plane

FIGURE 1. Layout for determination of residual magnetism in device.

3.11.1 Production lot designation. The production lot number shall follow MIL-STD-1168. The construction of the lot number shall be as follows:

XXX	93	D	002	-007
a	b	c	d	e

Where:

a = Manufacturer's identification code.
b = The year of manufacture of the oldest batch of propellant (cartridge or rocket motor) in the lot.
c = The month of manufacture of the oldest batch of propellant (cartridge or rocket motor) in the lot expressed as an alpha code in accordance with 4.1.3 of MIL-STD-1168.
d = Lot interfix number (controlled by Indian Head Division, Naval Surface Warfare Center, Code 5120, Indian Head, MD 20640-5000 or procuring activity).
e = Lot sequence number - lot number (manufacturer is responsible for the assignment of lot numbers.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.12 Workmanship. The workmanship shall be that required by the applicable drawings, referenced specifications, and the best industrial practices governing the quality production of interchangeable parts for maintaining the dimensions, finishes, tolerances, and quality specified herein. All components and assemblies shall be free from burrs, contamination, corrosion, sharp edges, or foreign material which could result in malfunction of the unit or components, or be a safety hazard in handling.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements (see 6.2).

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements; however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4)
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5)

4.3 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), inspection conditions shall be as follows:

a. Temperature: Room ambient 65 to 95°F
b. Altitude: Normal ground
c. Vibration: None
d. Humidity: Room ambient to 95 percent relative, maximum

4.4 First article inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), a first article sample shall consist of three blocks of cured propellant, two motor tube and grain assemblies, and 18 loaded rocket catapult assemblies. The rocket catapult assemblies shall be adapted for pressure transducers (see 6.8); and all first article sample shall be manufactured using the method and procedures proposed for production. The first article samples shall be subjected to the tests of 4.5, with the exception of the test firing of 4.5.5, followed by environmental testing, radiographic examination, and static firing in the sequence specified in table III. Acceptance of the first article sample shall be based on no defects in the sample. Any production of the rocket catapult assemblies by the contractor prior to approval of the first article samples shall be at the contractor's risk. First article samples shall not be included as part of the quantity specified for delivery in the contract (see 6.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE III. First article evaluation test program. 1/

Test Para.	Test	Unit Number																	
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
4.5.6.1	Radiographic inspection	a	a	a	a	a	a	a	a	a	a	a	a	a	a	a	a	a	a
4.4.1.1	High temperature	b	b	b	b	b	b												
4.4.1.2	Vibration −65°F							b	b	b									
4.4.1.2	Vibration 165°F										b	b	b						
4.4.1.4	30-day storage −65°F													b	b	b			
4.4.1.4	30-day storage 165°F																b	b	b
4.5.6.1	Radiographic inspection	c	c	c	c	c	c	c	c	c	c	c	c	c	c	c	c	c	c
4.4.1.3	Temperature shock	d	d	d	d	d	d	d	d	d	d	d	d						
4.5.6.1	Radiographic inspection	e	e	e	e	e	e	e	e	e	e	e	e						
4.4.2	Ballistic test −65°F	f	f					f			f			d			d		
4.4.2	Ballistic test 70°F			f	f				f			f			d			d	
4.4.2	Ballistic test 165°F					f	f			f			f			d			d

1/ Letters denote sequence of testing.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.1 Environmental tests.

4.4.1.1 High temperature. The rocket catapult assembly shall be subjected to the high-temperature storage test in accordance with Method 501 of MIL-STD-810. The test items shall be maintained at 165°F for 50 hours minimum. Operation of the rocket catapult shall be only as specified in table III.

4.4.1.2 Vibration. The rocket catapult assembly shall be subjected to random vibration for jet aircraft in accordance with MIL-STD-2102 with the exception that the duration shall be for 6 hours, with 2 hours on each axis. Before vibration, units shall be temperature conditioned in accordance with table III for a minimum of 8 hours. The input vibratory acceleration must have a W_o factor of 0.1 g^2/Hz and the reduction factor must be 0 g^2/Hz-dB. If the rocket catapult must be removed from the environmental conditioning chamber or if the temperature falls outside the specified temperature limits for more than 5 minutes, the testing shall be stopped and the unit reconditioned. A reconditioning time of 2 minutes for every minute outside the specified temperature envelope shall be required. A continuous temperature history of the unit will be kept for all conditioning and testing time. Unless otherwise noted, the rocket catapult shall be mounted on a test fixture in a manner that will simulate actual seat/aircraft installation and excited through the attachment fittings. In addition to compliance with the random vibration test, the rocket catapult shall comply with the gun fire vibration test of Method 519 of MIL-STD-810 for those applications whereby the guns are installed on the aircraft (see 6.2). However, if the maximum test spectrum level of the gun fire configuration is determined to be equal to or less than the MIL-STD-2102 test level, the gun fire vibration test shall not be required.

4.4.1.3 Temperature shock. The rocket catapult assembly shall be subjected to the temperature shock test in accordance with Method 503 of MIL-STD-810. The test temperature extremes shall be −65°F and 165°F and the duration of exposure at each temperature shall be 8 hours. Operation of the rocket catapult shall be only as specified in table III.

4.4.1.4 Thirty-day storage. Three rocket catapults shall be placed in storage at −65°F and three at 165°F for 30 days each. Ensuring that the proper temperature is maintained is the only attention required outside normal working hours.

4.4.2 Static firing test. Within 30 days after completion of environmental exposure the rocket catapults shall be static fired. The sample shall be temperature conditioned per table III for a minimum of 8 hours and test fired within 10 minutes after removal from the conditioning chamber to verify conformance to the requirements of 3.4. Data specified in table I shall be analyzed in accordance with MIL-STD-414, Section B, Part I, using the procedures of B-5 through B-7. Nonconformance with table I or any requirement of 3.4.1 shall be cause for rejection of the first article sample.

4.4.3 Propellant aging. Three blocks of cured propellant from each batch of propellant used in the first article sample shall be submitted for aging testing. High-temperature aging shall be conducted for 84 days with an atmosphere of 22 percent relative humidity and at 165 ± 5°F. At zero time and at the end of the 28-, 56-, and 84-day aging, physical properties shall conform to MIL-P-82680, Class III. The rate for stress/strain determination shall be 2.0 inches/minute. The sample shall be cast into rectangular cardboard containers approximately 1.5 inches high by 8 inches wide by 11 inches long. All samples submitted shall be bare propellant, individually wrapped in moistureproof packaging and properly identified as to propellant lot and batch number. Failure of the propellant to meet the requirements of MIL-P-82680, Class III shall be cause for rejection of the propellant batch.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.4 Propellant morphology. Two motor tube and grain assemblies from each batch of propellant used in the first article sample are to be submitted for morphological examination of the propellant. All samples shall be individually wrapped in moistureproof packaging and properly identified as to propellant lot, batch number, and grain serial number. These tests shall be used as baseline information.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall consist of the examinations and tests of 4.5.4 through 4.5.6, conducted on samples selected as specified in 4.5.2. The contractor is responsible for assuring that all rocket catapults offered for acceptance meet all requirements of the applicable drawings and specifications. Items of inspection shall be serialized and inspection data traceable to a specific serial number.

4.5.1 Test reports. When specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), the contractor shall furnish test reports (see 6.3) to the procuring activity. Test reports shall include the following information as described in 4.5.1.1 through 4.5.1.6:

a. Propellant description (see 3.2.2)
b. Static firing performance test results (see 4.5.5.1)
c. Summary sheet
d. Ammunition data cards
e. Propellant/assembly production records
f. Certification of age of explosive components and propellant (see 3.3)

4.5.1.1 Propellant description. The following propellant information shall be submitted with each production lot. The materials and components of each propellant batch should be listed with the manufacturer, lot number, and date of manufacture. The burning rates at 1000, 2500, 3000, 4000, and 5000 psi performed at −65°F, 70°F, and 165°F for each pressure (three samples at each temperature and pressure per batch) shall also be included. In addition, include the results of tensile strength and elongation tests at −65°F, 70°F, and 165°F with a pull rate of 2 inches/minute (five samples at each temperature per batch), heat of explosion (three samples per batch), and verification that ingredients were properly weighed and added to each batch (mix sheet).

4.5.1.2 Static firing performance tests. All computations and data required for ballistic evaluation generated during quality conformance inspection static firing per 4.5.5 (Government) and 4.5.5.1 (contractor) shall be reported, including firing traces. The following information shall also be listed:

a. Grain designation, manufacturer, lot number, and date of manufacture
b. Type of test equipment
c. Deviations from standard testing procedures
d. Additional comments (malfunctions, unusual occurances)
e. Disassembly findings report (see 4.5.5.2)

4.5.1.3 Summary sheet. A summary of the results of the tests for the parameters listed in table I shall be submitted to the designated Government activity for each inspection lot. The summary shall include the sample size, number and nature of defects found, and the disposition (accepted or rejected).

4.5.1.4 Data cards. Data cards (DD Form 1650) shall be completed for each loaded rocket catapult lot. Copies shall be provided in accordance with contract requirements and one copy shall be forwarded to the Commander, Indian Head Division, Naval Surface Warfare Center, Indian Head, MD 20640-5000 (Code 5120).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

4.5.1.5 Propellant/assembly production records. The contractor shall prepare propellant production records and retain them for the service life of the unit. These records shall include batch number, batch designation, rocket motor lot number, rocket motor serial number, cartridge lot number, and cartridge serial number. The records shall be cross referenced to the assembled rocket catapult lot number and to specific rocket catapult serial numbers.

4.5.2 Sampling for quality conformance inspection.

4.5.2.1 Lot. For the purpose of identification, inspection, and shipment, a lot of loaded assemblies shall consist of a maximum of 420 assemblies, including test samples. The homogeneity of inspection lots shall be retained as follows:

a. Components were produced by homogeneous process.
b. Units are loaded with same lot of rocket motors (see 6.4.10) and the same lot of catapult cartridges.

4.5.2.2 Sampling for examination. Designation of defects (critical, major, or minor) shall be in accordance with DOD-STD-2101.

a. Critical and major defects: Each rocket catapult assembly shall be examined for all critical and major defects.

b. Minor defects: Samples for examination shall be selected in accordance with inspection level II of MIL-STD-105.

c. Components: Unless a specific contractor-generated inspection plan for all subcontracted components has been approved by the procuring activity (see 4.5.4.3), the following sampling for components shall apply. All rocket catapult components shall be examined for all critical defects. Sampling for other defects shall be in accordance with level II of MIL-STD-105, AQL 1.0 for major defects and AQL 2.5 for minor defects.

4.5.2.3 Sampling for firing test. A sample of loaded rocket catapult assemblies shall be submitted for static firing in accordance with 4.5.5. The sample size shall be in accordance with table IV. Samples shall be chosen by a designated Government representative upon completion of the production lot assembly. Loaded rocket catapult samples shall not be preselected during production. Rocket catapults selected for samples shall not be included as part of the quantity specified for delivery in the contract or order. The ballistic sample size shall be divided as equally as possible among rocket motor batches and cartridge batches. From each rocket motor batch not represented in the sample rocket catapult assemblies, one sample rocket motor shall be selected for static firing by the contractor (see 4.5.5.1) so that at least one rocket motor from each rocket motor batch has been static fired.

4.5.2.4 Sampling for nondestructive test. Each rocket catapult assembly shall be subjected to the tests specified in 4.5.6.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE IV. Sample size for firing test.

Lot size	Total firing sample	Sample for temperature extreme
Up to 110	10	5
111 - 180	14	7
181 - 300	20	10
301 - 340	22	11
341 - 380	24	12
381 - 420	26	13

4.5.3 Resubmission of rejected lot. A sample of rocket catapult assemblies shall be selected in accordance with 4.5.2.3 and submitted when, with prior approval of the procuring activity, the contractor requests that the rejected lot be test fired under different conditions or the contractor believes a rejected lot may be reworked to meet the requirements of this specification.

4.5.4 Examination.

4.5.4.1 Critical and major defects. Each rocket catapult assembly shall be visually and radiograhically examined for critical and major defects specified in 4.5.2.2 and the applicable drawings. Any rocket catapult assembly found to contain a critical or major defect shall be rejected.

4.5.4.2 Minor defects. Sample rocket catapult assemblies selected in accordance with 4.5.2.2 b. shall be examined for minor defects in accordance with the applicable drawings, 3.8, 3.11, and 3.12. If any rocket catapult assembly is found to contain a minor defect, the rocket catapult lot shall be rejected. The lot may be resubmitted for examination of minor defects when all of the defective units are removed from the lot or all of the defects are corrected.

4.5.4.3 Component examination. Unless an alternative method is proposed, the rocket catapult components shall be examined in accordance with the applicable drawings and the sampling plan of 4.5.2.2 c. Any component found to contain a critical defect shall be rejected. If any component is found to contain a major or minor defect, the component lot shall be rejected. The component lot may be resubmitted for examination of major or minor defects when all of the defective units are removed from the lot or all of the defects are corrected. Alternative methods may be proposed and used with the approval of the procuring activity. The method shall be depicted in the contractor's product assurance quality program plan (see 6.3) and shall ensure that all fabricating and processing (of any type) are accomplished under the controlled conditions which are monitored and accepted by the procuring activity. Systematic control is required for all facets of work to assure all dimensions and requirements are met. This control can be accomplished through direct or indirect inspection, process monitoring, or statistical process control, or a combination of all four. Inspection for rubber O-rings shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-413.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.5 Production lot acceptance firing. Rocket catapults selected in accordance with 4.5.2.3 shall be static fired within 30 days after submission for acceptance of the rocket catapult lot. The sample catapults shall be divided into two equal groups with one group conditioned at $-65 \pm 2°F$ and the other group conditioned at $165 \pm 2°F$. Each group shall be conditioned for a minimum of 8 hours. The catapults shall be fired within 10 minutes after removal from the conditioning chamber. Minimum equipment accuracies shall be as shown in table V. Data specified in table I shall be analyzed in accordance with MIL-STD-414, Section B, Part I, using the procedures of B-5 through B-7. Nonconformance with table I or any requirement of 3.4 shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

TABLE V. Test equipment accuracies.

Measured Characteristic	Equipment Accuracy
Maximum thrust	± 2.0 percent
Time	± 0.001 second
Maximum acceleration	± 5 percent
Pressure	± 2.0 percent
Temperature	± 2.0°F

4.5.5.1 Contractor batch acceptance test firing. Rocket motors selected by the contractor to meet the requirements of 4.5.2.3 shall be static fired by the contractor as rocket motor batch acceptance tests. The sample rocket motors shall be divided into two equal groups with one group conditioned at $-65 \pm 2°F$ and one group at $165 \pm 2°F$. Each group shall be conditioned for a minimum of 8 hours. The rocket motors shall be fired within 10 minutes after removal from the conditioning chamber. Minimum equipment accuracies shall be as shown in table V. Failure of any rocket motor to meet the requirements of 3.4 shall be cause for rejection of the specific batch of rocket motors.

4.5.5.2 Post static-firing disassembly. A post firing disassembly and inspection shall be conducted on all first article, lot acceptance, and batch acceptance test units. Detailed observations on conditions, including marginal conditions of individual components, shall be noted. All findings shall be evaluated against the requirements of 3.4.1.1. When specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), a disassembly findings report shall be submitted to the contracting activity.

4.5.6 Nondestructive tests. Each rocket catapult assembly shall be subjected to the following tests. When specified in the contract (see 6.2), the contractor shall furnish test reports (see 6.3) detailing the results of all nondestructive tests for each lot of rocket catapults.

4.5.6.1 Radiographic inspection. Rocket catapults shall be radiographically inspected in accordance with MIL-STD-453, radiographic quality level I. Any deficiency shall be cause for rejection of the unit. Radiographs shall be capable of detecting defects and rocket catapult components 0.03 inch in length or width. When specified in the contract (see 6.2), all radiographs taken of the rocket catapult assembly or components thereof shall be forwarded to the activity designated by the contracting activity. Otherwise, all radiographs shall

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

be inspected on-site by a designated Government representative. Acceptance of the loaded rocket catapult lot shall be subject to approval of the radiographs by the designated Government activity.

4.5.6.2 Hydrostatic pressure. Each component listed shall be subjected to the respective internal hydrostatic pressure specified in table II for a minimum of 15 seconds without application of an external load. Any leakage, permanent deformation outside drawing tolerances, or mechanical failure shall result in rejection of that component. Each hydrostatically tested component shall then be subjected to the magnetic particle inspection of 4.5.6.3.

4.5.6.3 Magnetic particle inspection. Each motor tube, booster tube, and launcher tube shall be 100 percent magnetic particle inspected in accordance with MIL-STD-1949. Discontinuities exceeding one-half the maximum size permitted by MIL-STD-1907, Grade A, Table I, are unacceptable.

4.5.6.4 Radiographic inspection. Each breech assembly shall be 100 percent radiographically inspected in accordance with MIL-STD-453, radiographic quality level I. Any deficiency shall be cause for rejection of the assembly.

4.5.6.5 Penetrant inspection. Each breech, prior to anodizing, shall be 100 percent penetrant inspected in accordance with ASTM E 165. Linear indications are unacceptable. Rounded penetrant indications limited to 1/64-inch diameter are permissible, provided a maximum of 15 such indications per square inch are present.

4.5.6.6 Torque. After ascertaining that each booster tube and breech assembly has been seated with 400 +50, −0 inch-pounds of torque, a breakaway torque of 200 inch-pounds shall be applied. Any evidence of loosening or deformation of the booster tube and breech assembly shall result in rejection of the part.

4.5.6.7 Residual magnetism. Each rocket catapult assembly shall be passed 6 inches in front of an MS17983 compass along the entire length of the catapult in accordance with figure 1. If the compass indicator deflects more than 5 degrees in either direction the rocket catapult assembly shall be rejected.

4.6 Packaging inspection. The packaging, packing, and marking shall be inspected to verify conformance to the requirements of Section 5.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation, packaging, and packing. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), preservation, packaging, and packing shall be level A.

5.1.1 Level A. Preservation, packaging, and packing shall be in accordance with the drawings listed on DL6610113 and MIL-P-116. Containers shall conform to Uniform Freight Classification, National Motor Freight Classification, or to rules of other carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2 Marking. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order (see 6.2), each container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129, drawings listed on DL6610113, and Code of Federal Requlations 49 CFR 171-178 (see 6.7).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful but is not mandatory).

6.1 Intended use. The CKU-5B/A Aircraft Ejection Seat Catapult Assembly is intended to be used to propel an aircraft ejection seat and its occupant safely out and away from a jet aircraft.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.

b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation and, if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1, 2.1.2, and 2.2).

c. Whether a first article sample is required (see 3.1, 4.4 and 6.5).

d. Instructions for adaption of first article samples for pressure transducers (see 3.1.1 and 6.5).

e. Assigned activity for first article inspection and static firing tests (see 4.4, 4.4.2, 4.5.2.3, 4.5.5, and 6.9).

f. Whether the gun fire vibration test is required (see 4.4.1.2).

g. Whether test reports are required (see 4.5.1, 4.5.5.2, and 4.5.6).

h. When radiographs are to be furnished to the Government (see 4.5.6.1).

i. Packaging requirements, if other than level A (see 5.1).

j. Any special markings required (see 5.2).

k. Disposition of hardware, scrap propellant, and metal parts (see 6.10).

l. Inspection conditions, if other than as specified (see 4.3).

m. When a Product Assurance Quality Program is required.

n. That the safety precaution requirements of the "Contractor's Safety Manual for Ammunition, Explosives, and Related Dangerous Material," DOD 4145.26M are applicable. NOTE: When this specification is used as part of the description of work to be accomplished by a Government activity, the safety precaution requirements of "Ammunition and Explosives Ashore" OP 5 are applicable.

6.3 Data requirements. The following data requirements should be considered when this specification is applied on a contract. The applicable Data Item Descriptions (DID's) should be reviewed in conjunction with the specific acquisition to ensure that only essential data are requested/provided and that the DID's are tailored

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

to reflect the requirements of the specific acquisition. To ensure correct contractual application of the data requirements, a Contract Data Requirements List (DD Form 1423) must be prepared to obtain the data, except where DOD FAR Supplement 27.475-1 exempts the requirement for a DD Form 1423.

Ref. Paragraph	DID Number	DID Title	Tailoring
4.5.1, 4.5.5.2, 4.5.6	DI-T-2072	Reports, Test	—
4.5.1	DI-MISC-80043	Ammunition Data Card	—
4.5.1	UDI-A-23264B	Certification Data/Report	—
4.5.4.3	DI-QCIC-81198	Product Assurance Quality Program Plan	—

(The above DID's were those cleared as of the date of this specification. The current issue of DOD 5010.12-L, Acquisition Management Systems and Data Requirements Control List (AMSDL), must be researched to ensure that only current, cleared DID's are cited on the DD Form 1423.)

6.4 Definitions.

6.4.1 Rocket motor resultant impulse. The rocket motor resultant impulse is obtained by vectorially adding the longitudinal and normal impulse of the rocket motor taken over the action time.

6.4.2 Rocket motor action time. Action time is determined from the normal thrust-time curve, and shall be defined as the time interval from the 10 percent of maximum thrust on the initial rise of curve to the corresponding 10 percent of thrust on the declining portion of the curve.

6.4.3 Rocket motor resultant thrust. The rocket motor resultant thrust is obtained by vectorially adding the two maximum components of rocket thrust that occur at one time.

6.4.4 Rocket motor ignition delay. Rocket motor ignition time is the elapsed time from separation (the point on the catapult thrust truce where the trace begins to drop sharply) to 10 percent of maximum thrust, as measured on the rising portion of the normal component rocket thrust trace.

6.4.5 Catapult ignition delay time. Catapult ignition delay time is the elapsed time from the first indication of shearing of the firing pin shear pins to first indication of catapult thrust.

6.4.6 Catapult separation velocity. Catapult separation velocity is defined as the average velocity of the simulated ejected weight propelled horizontally at catapult separation measured over the interval from separation to 12 inches after separation.

6.4.7 Catapult dynamic response index (DRI). DRI is representative of the maximum compression of the vertebral column of the human body, as defined in MIL-S-9479.

6.4.8 Propellant batch. A propellant batch is a mix of ingredients, each ingredient composed of one homogeneous lot, that is mixed at one time in one vessel, resulting in a homogeneous mixture.

6.4.9 Rocket motor batch. A rocket motor batch is a group of rocket motors cast from one propellant batch.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.4.10 Rocket motor lot. A rocket motor lot is a group of rocket motors composed of one or more rocket motor batches all having the same ingredient lots.

6.4.11 Rocket catapult lot. A rocket catapult lot is a group of units composed of one lot of rocket motors and one lot of catapult cartridges that are assembled at one time.

6.4.12 Primary components. Primary components are all components containing explosive ingredients. This includes the cartridge percussion primer, the cartridge, the rocket motor, and the rocket motor igniter(s).

6.5 First article. When first article inspection is required, the contracting officer should provide specific guidance to offerors whether the items should be a first article sample or a sample selected from the first production items (see 3.1), and the number of items to be tested as specified in 4.4. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examination, approval of first article test results, and disposition of first articles. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or test, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract. Bidders should not submit alternate bids unless specifically requested to do so in the solicitation.

6.6 Hazard notice. The rocket catapult described herein and certain of its components are flammable or explosive and present hazards in manufacture, handling, storage, and shipment. The contractor should recognize these properties and take appropriate measures to guard and protect against fire, explosion, adverse environment, corrosive atmosphere, rough handling, and electrically induced incidents.

6.7 Explosive hazard classification. The explosive hazard classification for this rocket catapult has been designated as:

Explosive Hazard Classification — Class 1, Division 3
Storage Compatibility Group — Group C
Department of Transportation (DOT) Hazard Class — Class B
DOT Marking — Rocket Motors

6.8 Pressure transducers. Instructions for adapting the first article catapult assemblies for pressure transducers should be compatible with instruments having a response not less than 600 Hz and that are capable of detecting ignition peak pressures and unstable burning rates.

6.9 Test facility. The Indian Head Division, Naval Surface Warfare Center, Indian Head, MD is the design agent for the product covered by this specification. As such, they are equipped to perform the first article inspection and static firing tests specified herein. Except when special conditions warrant otherwise, the Indian Head Division, Naval Surface Warfare Center, Indian Head, MD should be designated as the test facility for the first article inspection and the production acceptance test firings.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.10 Disposition of hardware, scrap propellant, and metal parts. The contract shall specify that:

a. all items purchased become the property of the U.S. Government
b. no hardware, propellant, or metal parts shall be disposed of without authorization of the procuring activity
c. all items be made available to the procuring activity upon request
d. the disposition of any tested hardware, propellant, or metal parts without authorization by the procuring activity will result in the test being declared invalid, and a retest will be required.

6.11 Retention of radiographs. All radiographs of accepted lots of rocket catapults are to be retained on file by the contractor for 9 years or 1 year past the service life of the unit, whichever is longer.

6.12 Service life. The rocket catapult has a design life of 8 years and an installed service life of 8 years from the date of propellant manufacture.

6.13 Subject term (keyword) listing.

Rocket catapult
Rocket motor

Preparing activity:
Navy - OS
(Project 1377-NE56)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-C-82876(OS)	1993 NOVEMBER 15

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
CATAPULT, AIRCRAFT EJECTION SEAT, CKU-5B/A ASSEMBLY

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code)	
COMMANDER INDIAN HEAD DIVISION, NSWC	(1) Commercial 301-743-4510/4358	(2) AUTOVON 354-4510/4358
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) 101 STRAUSS AVENUE CODE 8420 INDIAN HEAD, MD 20640-5035	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026/10-26T04:42Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.